

THE 24TH

Full Development-to-Steam Publishing Checklist

A step-by-step production tracker for building, testing, packaging, publishing, launching, and supporting the game on Steam.

Workflow: Unreal Engine 5.7 + Codex + NoGlyph Blueprint Stack + GitHub + Steamworks

Working Title	The 24th
Genre	First-Person Arena Survival / Survival Combat / PvE-PvNPC
Primary Platform	PC / Steam Early Access first
Core Loop	Rise into the Dome -> scavenge -> survive -> craft -> hunt/hide/fight -> outlast -> ascend
Primary Build Method	Blueprint-first, with modular systems and AI-assisted implementation
Document Version	v0.1 - checklist companion to the GDD

How to use this PDF: print it, mark it up digitally, or copy tasks into GitHub Issues. Each checkbox is intentionally small and concrete so you can track progress without losing the big picture.

Checklist Overview

This document follows the full production journey: idea, planning, Unreal setup, Codex/NoGlyph workflow, playable prototype, vertical slice, full production, QA, Steamworks, store page, SteamPipe builds, review, launch, and post-launch support.

The recommended rhythm is: define a small milestone, build it in a test map, test it, fix it, commit it, record devlog evidence, then move to the next milestone.

Major Milestone Gates

- [] OV.01 - Concept gate: the game identity, IP-safe terminology, and prototype scope are locked.
- [] OV.02 - Foundation gate: Unreal project, folders, Git, Git LFS, maps, inputs, data assets, and empty Blueprints exist.
- [] OV.03 - Core systems gate: movement, survival stats, HUD, interaction, inventory, hotbar, crafting, and basic combat work in Map_TestSystems.
- [] OV.04 - Arena gate: elevator intro, Core placeholder, Boundary Field, Survivor count, and match state work in Map_TestArena.
- [] OV.05 - AI gate: NPC Survivors can spawn, choose simple goals, fight, flee, die, and update Survivor count.
- [] OV.06 - Vertical slice gate: one complete match can be played from elevator intro to death/victory.
- [] OV.07 - Alpha gate: all planned major systems exist, even if rough.
- [] OV.08 - Beta gate: all systems are content-complete, performance is stable, and external playtest feedback is being fixed.
- [] OV.09 - Steam gate: store page, builds, depots, graphical assets, pricing, and review checklist are complete.
- [] OV.10 - Launch gate: approved build is live, store page is live, launch posts are ready, and post-launch support plan is active.

Phase 0 - Project Vision, Scope, and IP Safety

Goal: Lock the creative foundation before production begins.

PHASE GATE: Move on only when the concept is clear, original, small enough to prototype, and legally safer than a direct imitation of existing IP.

0.1 Core Identity

- [] 0.1.01 - Write the one-sentence pitch: 24 Survivors enter The Dome and only one becomes the Ascendant.
- [] 0.1.02 - Confirm the working title The 24th is used internally until legal/title availability is checked.
- [] 0.1.03 - Define the game as arena survival first, not a political rebellion story.
- [] 0.1.04 - Confirm the game begins with an elevator/pod ascent into the arena.
- [] 0.1.05 - Confirm the player is Survivor 24 by default.
- [] 0.1.06 - Confirm the 23 other Survivors are NPCs for the first version.
- [] 0.1.07 - Confirm no base building is planned for the first version.
- [] 0.1.08 - Confirm first-person is the default prototype camera.
- [] 0.1.09 - Confirm optional third-person toggle is future scope only.
- [] 0.1.10 - Create a short public-safe description for devlogs and Steam drafts.

0.2 IP-Safe Terminology

- [] 0.2.01 - Use Survivors instead of Tributes.
- [] 0.2.02 - Use The Dome instead of direct franchise arena language.
- [] 0.2.03 - Use The Core instead of Cornucopia.
- [] 0.2.04 - Use The Operators instead of Gamemakers.
- [] 0.2.05 - Use Selection or Intake instead of Reaping.
- [] 0.2.06 - Use Boundary Field instead of franchise-specific forcefield wording.
- [] 0.2.07 - Use Bioforms instead of mutts/mutations.
- [] 0.2.08 - Use Ascendant instead of Victor.
- [] 0.2.09 - Avoid district-based world structure.
- [] 0.2.10 - Avoid rebellion symbols, slogans, salutes, and character parallels.
- [] 0.2.11 - Avoid direct names, visual references, or story beats from existing books/movies.
- [] 0.2.12 - Create an IP-safe vocabulary page in the project docs.

0.3 Scope Lock

- [] 0.3.01 - Define the first prototype as one small test arena, not the full game.
- [] 0.3.02 - Define the first playable goal: rise into arena, loot, survive, craft, fight/avoid, win/die.
- [] 0.3.03 - Define must-have prototype systems.
- [] 0.3.04 - Define should-have prototype systems.
- [] 0.3.05 - Define nice-to-have systems that must not block the prototype.
- [] 0.3.06 - Move multiplayer into future scope.
- [] 0.3.07 - Move full Steam integration into future scope after vertical slice.
- [] 0.3.08 - Move complex procedural arena generation into future scope.
- [] 0.3.09 - Move deep character backstories into future scope.
- [] 0.3.10 - Write a clear anti-scope-creep note in the dev checklist.

Phase 1 - Documentation, Repo, and Remote Work Foundation

Goal: Prepare the project so work can continue from home, cafe, or Unreal PC without losing structure.

PHASE GATE: Move on when documents, repository, issues, backups, and naming rules are ready.

1.1 Local Project Folder

- [] 1.1.01 - Create a master folder named The24th_Project.
- [] 1.1.02 - Create Documents folder for GDD, checklist, prompt packs, notes, and changelogs.
- [] 1.1.03 - Create References folder for UI, arena, mood, and art references.
- [] 1.1.04 - Create Unreal_Project folder for the future UE project.
- [] 1.1.05 - Create Exports folder for PDFs, devlog scripts, images, and thumbnails.
- [] 1.1.06 - Create Marketing folder for Steam copy, screenshots, trailers, press kit, and YouTube content.
- [] 1.1.07 - Create Legal folder for license notes, title checks, asset licenses, music licenses, and contracts.
- [] 1.1.08 - Create Builds folder outside the Git repo for packaged builds.
- [] 1.1.09 - Create Backups folder for manual milestone snapshots.
- [] 1.1.10 - Add a README explaining the folder purpose.

1.2 GitHub Repository

- [] 1.2.01 - Create the GitHub repository for The24th.
- [] 1.2.02 - Add README.md with the project summary.
- [] 1.2.03 - Add LICENSE placeholder or private license note.
- [] 1.2.04 - Add .gitignore suitable for Unreal Engine projects.
- [] 1.2.05 - Set up Git LFS for Unreal binary assets before adding uasset/umap files.
- [] 1.2.06 - Add docs folder for markdown planning files.
- [] 1.2.07 - Commit the GDD PDF and markdown planning notes if desired.
- [] 1.2.08 - Push the initial repo to GitHub.
- [] 1.2.09 - Create branch naming rules: main, dev, feature/system-name, fix/bug-name.
- [] 1.2.10 - Create a policy: no direct experimental commits to main.

1.3 GitHub Issues and Project Board

- [] 1.3.01 - Create milestones: Foundation, Prototype, Vertical Slice, Alpha, Beta, Steam Launch.
- [] 1.3.02 - Create labels: planning, unreal, blueprint, ai, ui, combat, inventory, ai-npc, steam, bug, polish, blocker.
- [] 1.3.03 - Create issue template for feature tasks.
- [] 1.3.04 - Create issue template for bugs.
- [] 1.3.05 - Create issue template for playtest feedback.
- [] 1.3.06 - Create issue template for asset requests.
- [] 1.3.07 - Create GitHub Project board columns: Backlog, Ready, In Progress, Testing, Done, Blocked.
- [] 1.3.08 - Add the first 20 foundation tasks as issues.
- [] 1.3.09 - Link issues to milestones.
- [] 1.3.10 - Add a rule: every committed feature should reference an issue number.

1.4 Remote Work Rules

- [] 1.4.01 - Define what can be edited away from the Unreal PC: docs, prompts, configs, markdown, CSV/JSON, code files.
- [] 1.4.02 - Define what should not be edited away from Unreal: .uasset, .umap, Blueprint graphs, widget assets, materials.
- [] 1.4.03 - Create a remote-work note for cafe sessions using VS Code + Codex only.
- [] 1.4.04 - Create a home-work note for Unreal + NoGlyph sessions.
- [] 1.4.05 - Add a pull-before-work rule.
- [] 1.4.06 - Add a commit-before-shutdown rule.
- [] 1.4.07 - Add a backup-before-plugin-install rule.
- [] 1.4.08 - Add a no-unreal-asset-manual-editing-in-VS-Code warning.
- [] 1.4.09 - Create a sync checklist for switching between laptop/cafe and main PC.
- [] 1.4.10 - Test cloning or pulling the repo on a secondary machine.

Phase 2 - Hardware, Software, Accounts, and Tooling

Goal: Install and verify the tools required to build, package, and publish the game.

PHASE GATE: Move on when the development PC can open Unreal, compile/package test builds, connect to GitHub, and run the AI workflow.

2.1 PC and OS Readiness

- ☐ 2.1.01 - Update Windows 11.
- ☐ 2.1.02 - Update NVIDIA GPU drivers.
- ☐ 2.1.03 - Confirm enough free SSD space for Unreal projects and DerivedDataCache.
- ☐ 2.1.04 - Create a dedicated Unreal projects drive/folder.
- ☐ 2.1.05 - Create a separate Builds output folder outside the repo.
- ☐ 2.1.06 - Confirm antivirus exclusions are reasonable for Unreal build folders if needed.
- ☐ 2.1.07 - Confirm the PC can run Unreal 5.7 First Person template smoothly.
- ☐ 2.1.08 - Create a restore point or full backup before major tool installs.
- ☐ 2.1.09 - Install 7-Zip or similar archive tool.
- ☐ 2.1.10 - Install a screen recorder for devlog capture.

2.2 Unreal and Development Tools

- ☐ 2.2.01 - Install Unreal Engine 5.7 through Epic Games Launcher.
- ☐ 2.2.02 - Install Visual Studio Build Tools if required for packaging or C++.
- ☐ 2.2.03 - Install VS Code.
- ☐ 2.2.04 - Install Git.
- ☐ 2.2.05 - Install Git LFS.
- ☐ 2.2.06 - Install GitHub Desktop or configure command-line Git.
- ☐ 2.2.07 - Install Codex/VS Code workflow tools used for repo editing.
- ☐ 2.2.08 - Install image editing tool for UI mockups and Steam capsules.
- ☐ 2.2.09 - Install audio editor or DAW for basic SFX processing.
- ☐ 2.2.10 - Install compression/packaging utilities if needed.

2.3 Accounts

- ☐ 2.3.01 - Confirm Epic Games account access.
- ☐ 2.3.02 - Confirm GitHub account access.
- ☐ 2.3.03 - Confirm OpenAI/Codex access.
- ☐ 2.3.04 - Create or confirm NoGlyph account/Fab purchase path.
- ☐ 2.3.05 - Create or confirm Steam account for Steamworks.
- ☐ 2.3.06 - Enable 2FA on GitHub.
- ☐ 2.3.07 - Enable Steam Guard on Steam account.
- ☐ 2.3.08 - Store account recovery codes securely.
- ☐ 2.3.09 - Create a business email address for the game/studio if needed.
- ☐ 2.3.10 - Create a simple password manager entry group for The 24th.

2.4 NoGlyph Purchase Prep

- ☐ 2.4.01 - Review NoGlyph Blueprint Stack docs and tutorials.
- ☐ 2.4.02 - Confirm UE version compatibility before purchase.
- ☐ 2.4.03 - Confirm pricing and license terms.
- ☐ 2.4.04 - Join the NoGlyph Discord community if helpful.
- ☐ 2.4.05 - Bookmark NoGlyph documentation.
- ☐ 2.4.06 - Create a NoGlyph setup checklist in the repo.
- ☐ 2.4.07 - Prepare a throwaway UE project for first NoGlyph test.
- ☐ 2.4.08 - Prepare a test prompt for creating a simple Health variable.
- ☐ 2.4.09 - Prepare rollback strategy before installing the plugin in the main project.
- ☐ 2.4.10 - Do not let NoGlyph modify the real project until plugin test succeeds.

Phase 3 - Unreal Project Creation and Baseline Setup

Goal: Create a clean Unreal project with correct settings and source control before adding gameplay logic.

PHASE GATE: Move on when Unreal opens cleanly, maps exist, folders exist, Git works, and the first baseline commit is complete.

3.1 Create the Project

- [] 3.1.01 - Open Unreal Engine 5.7.
- [] 3.1.02 - Create a Games project.
- [] 3.1.03 - Select First Person template.
- [] 3.1.04 - Choose Blueprint project type for prototype.
- [] 3.1.05 - Set target platform to Desktop.
- [] 3.1.06 - Set project name to The24th without spaces.
- [] 3.1.07 - Disable ray tracing for prototype unless explicitly needed.
- [] 3.1.08 - Decide whether to include Starter Content.
- [] 3.1.09 - Create project inside Unreal_Project folder.
- [] 3.1.10 - Open project and verify it launches without errors.

3.2 First Clean Save and Backup

- [] 3.2.01 - Open the default map.
- [] 3.2.02 - Run Play-In-Editor once.
- [] 3.2.03 - Save all assets.
- [] 3.2.04 - Close Unreal.
- [] 3.2.05 - Copy the clean project to a backup folder.
- [] 3.2.06 - Reopen the main project.
- [] 3.2.07 - Verify backup is not inside the repo.
- [] 3.2.08 - Document the backup location.
- [] 3.2.09 - Create first baseline Git commit.
- [] 3.2.10 - Push baseline commit to GitHub.

3.3 Plugins to Enable

- [] 3.3.01 - Confirm Enhanced Input is enabled.
- [] 3.3.02 - Enable Gameplay Tags.
- [] 3.3.03 - Enable AI/Behavior Tree related tools if not already active.
- [] 3.3.04 - Enable Navigation System features as needed.
- [] 3.3.05 - Enable Niagara for future VFX.
- [] 3.3.06 - Enable Modeling Tools Editor Mode.
- [] 3.3.07 - Enable PCG only if required for later arena/environment work.
- [] 3.3.08 - Avoid enabling Steam/multiplayer plugins too early.
- [] 3.3.09 - Restart Unreal after plugin changes.
- [] 3.3.10 - Commit plugin/project setting changes.

3.4 Project Settings Baseline

- [] 3.4.01 - Set project description fields.
- [] 3.4.02 - Set company/project display name placeholders.
- [] 3.4.03 - Set default maps to Map_TestSystems after creating it.
- [] 3.4.04 - Set default GameMode later after BP_TrialGameMode exists.
- [] 3.4.05 - Set input system to Enhanced Input workflow.
- [] 3.4.06 - Set target frame-rate policy for testing if needed.
- [] 3.4.07 - Set packaging target to Windows initially.
- [] 3.4.08 - Set project thumbnail/icon placeholder later.
- [] 3.4.09 - Save project settings.
- [] 3.4.10 - Commit project settings changes.

Phase 4 - Unreal Folder Structure, Naming, Maps, and Empty Assets

Goal: Create the full Unreal skeleton before AI starts wiring logic.

PHASE GATE: Move on when all required folders, maps, enums, structs, data tables, widgets, and empty Blueprints exist.

4.1 Content Folder Structure

- [] 4.1.01 - Create /Game/The24th root folder.
- [] 4.1.02 - Create /Game/The24th/Blueprints.
- [] 4.1.03 - Create /Game/The24th/Blueprints/Player.
- [] 4.1.04 - Create /Game/The24th/Blueprints/AI.
- [] 4.1.05 - Create /Game/The24th/Blueprints/Components.
- [] 4.1.06 - Create /Game/The24th/Blueprints/Survival.
- [] 4.1.07 - Create /Game/The24th/Blueprints/Inventory.
- [] 4.1.08 - Create /Game/The24th/Blueprints/Crafting.
- [] 4.1.09 - Create /Game/The24th/Blueprints/Combat.
- [] 4.1.10 - Create /Game/The24th/Blueprints/Interaction.
- [] 4.1.11 - Create /Game/The24th/Blueprints/Arena.
- [] 4.1.12 - Create /Game/The24th/Blueprints/Events.
- [] 4.1.13 - Create /Game/The24th/Blueprints/World.
- [] 4.1.14 - Create /Game/The24th/Blueprints/Items.
- [] 4.1.15 - Create /Game/The24th/Blueprints/UI.
- [] 4.1.16 - Create /Game/The24th/Blueprints/SaveLoad.
- [] 4.1.17 - Create /Game/The24th/Data.
- [] 4.1.18 - Create /Game/The24th/UI.
- [] 4.1.19 - Create /Game/The24th/Maps.
- [] 4.1.20 - Create /Game/The24th/Art.
- [] 4.1.21 - Create /Game/The24th/Audio.
- [] 4.1.22 - Create /Game/The24th/Input.
- [] 4.1.23 - Create /Game/The24th/Dev.
- [] 4.1.24 - Fix up redirectors after folder creation.

4.2 Maps

- [] 4.2.01 - Create Map_MainMenu.
- [] 4.2.02 - Create Map_TestSystems.
- [] 4.2.03 - Create Map_TestArena.
- [] 4.2.04 - Create Map_PrototypeDome.
- [] 4.2.05 - Set Map_TestSystems as Editor Startup Map.
- [] 4.2.06 - Set Map_TestSystems as Game Default Map for now.
- [] 4.2.07 - Add a Player Start to Map_TestSystems.
- [] 4.2.08 - Add simple lighting to Map_TestSystems.
- [] 4.2.09 - Add a flat floor to Map_TestSystems.
- [] 4.2.10 - Save all maps.
- [] 4.2.11 - Commit map creation.

4.3 Core Empty Blueprints

- [] 4.3.01 - Create BP_PlayerSurvivorCharacter.
- [] 4.3.02 - Create BP_PlayerSurvivorController.
- [] 4.3.03 - Create BP_TrialGameMode.
- [] 4.3.04 - Create BP_TrialGameState.
- [] 4.3.05 - Create BP_TrialPlayerState.
- [] 4.3.06 - Create BP_The24thGameInstance.
- [] 4.3.07 - Create BP_ElevatorPod.
- [] 4.3.08 - Create BP_CoreSupplyCrate.
- [] 4.3.09 - Create BP_BoundaryFieldVolume.

- [] 4.3.10 - Create BP_ZoneVolume.
- [] 4.3.11 - Create BP_ExtractionGate.
- [] 4.3.12 - Create BP_ArenaEventManager.
- [] 4.3.13 - Create BP_SupplyDropPod.
- [] 4.3.14 - Create BP_DangerZoneVolume.
- [] 4.3.15 - Compile and save all empty Blueprints.

4.4 Empty Actor Components

- [] 4.4.01 - Create BP_SurvivalStatsComponent.
- [] 4.4.02 - Create BP_InventoryComponent.
- [] 4.4.03 - Create BP_HotbarComponent.
- [] 4.4.04 - Create BP_CraftingComponent.
- [] 4.4.05 - Create BP_CombatComponent.
- [] 4.4.06 - Create BP_InteractionComponent.
- [] 4.4.07 - Create BP_StealthComponent.
- [] 4.4.08 - Create BP_NoiseComponent.
- [] 4.4.09 - Create BP_StatusEffectsComponent.
- [] 4.4.10 - Create BP_EquipmentComponent.
- [] 4.4.11 - Compile and save all components.

4.5 Interfaces

- [] 4.5.01 - Create BPI_Interactable.
- [] 4.5.02 - Create BPI_Damageable.
- [] 4.5.03 - Create BPI_Lootable.
- [] 4.5.04 - Create BPI_Harvestable.
- [] 4.5.05 - Create BPI_Equippable.
- [] 4.5.06 - Create BPI_UsableItem.
- [] 4.5.07 - Create BPI_ArenaEventReceiver.
- [] 4.5.08 - Compile and save interfaces.
- [] 4.5.09 - Document interface purpose in README or notes.
- [] 4.5.10 - Commit interface assets.

4.6 UI Widget Shells

- [] 4.6.01 - Create WBP_HUD.
- [] 4.6.02 - Create WBP_Inventory.
- [] 4.6.03 - Create WBP_Hotbar.
- [] 4.6.04 - Create WBP_CraftingMenu.
- [] 4.6.05 - Create WBP_InteractionPrompt.
- [] 4.6.06 - Create WBP_NotificationFeed.
- [] 4.6.07 - Create WBP_MatchStatus.
- [] 4.6.08 - Create WBP_PauseMenu.
- [] 4.6.09 - Create WBP_MainMenu.
- [] 4.6.10 - Create WBP_SettingsMenu.
- [] 4.6.11 - Create WBP_DeathScreen.
- [] 4.6.12 - Create WBP_VictoryScreen.
- [] 4.6.13 - Create WBP_LoadingScreen.
- [] 4.6.14 - Add placeholder canvases only, no logic yet.
- [] 4.6.15 - Commit widget shells.

Phase 5 - Data Foundations: Enums, Structs, Tables, Tags, Inputs

Goal: Prepare data-first architecture so systems are modular and easier for Codex/NoGlyph to wire.

PHASE GATE: Move on when all starter data assets exist and the first rows are populated for testing.

5.1 Enums

- [] 5.1.01 - Create E_ItemType.
- [] 5.1.02 - Create E_ItemRarity.
- [] 5.1.03 - Create E_WeaponType.
- [] 5.1.04 - Create E_DamageType.
- [] 5.1.05 - Create E_StatusEffectType.
- [] 5.1.06 - Create E_SurvivorArchetype.
- [] 5.1.07 - Create E_NPCGoalState.
- [] 5.1.08 - Create E_NPCDetectionState.
- [] 5.1.09 - Create E_MatchPhase.
- [] 5.1.10 - Create E_ArenaEventType.
- [] 5.1.11 - Create E_ZoneType.
- [] 5.1.12 - Create E_WeatherType.
- [] 5.1.13 - Create E_Difficulty.
- [] 5.1.14 - Save and commit enums.

5.2 Structs

- [] 5.2.01 - Create ST_ItemData.
- [] 5.2.02 - Create ST_InventorySlot.
- [] 5.2.03 - Create ST_CraftingRecipe.
- [] 5.2.04 - Create ST_RequiredItem.
- [] 5.2.05 - Create ST_NPCSurvivorData.
- [] 5.2.06 - Create ST_ArenaEventData.
- [] 5.2.07 - Create ST_LootTableEntry.
- [] 5.2.08 - Create ST_DifficultySettings.
- [] 5.2.09 - Create ST_ZoneData.
- [] 5.2.10 - Create ST_StatusEffectData.
- [] 5.2.11 - Create ST_WeaponStats.
- [] 5.2.12 - Save and commit structs.

5.3 Data Tables

- [] 5.3.01 - Create DT_Items.
- [] 5.3.02 - Add starter item rows: Wood, Stone, Fibre, Herb.
- [] 5.3.03 - Add starter food/water rows: RawMeat, CookedMeat, WaterPouch.
- [] 5.3.04 - Add starter medicine row: Bandage.
- [] 5.3.05 - Add starter weapons: StoneKnife, WoodenSpear, ShortBow, Arrow.
- [] 5.3.06 - Create DT_CraftingRecipes.
- [] 5.3.07 - Add starter recipes: StoneKnife, WoodenSpear, Bandage, ShortBow, Arrow.
- [] 5.3.08 - Create DT_NPCSurvivors.
- [] 5.3.09 - Add 5 starter NPC rows with archetypes.
- [] 5.3.10 - Create DT_NPCArchetypes.
- [] 5.3.11 - Create DT_ArenaEvents.
- [] 5.3.12 - Create DT_LootTables.
- [] 5.3.13 - Create DT_DifficultySettings.
- [] 5.3.14 - Create DT_ZoneData.
- [] 5.3.15 - Create DT_WeaponStats.
- [] 5.3.16 - Save and commit data tables.

5.4 Enhanced Input

- [] 5.4.01 - Create IA_Move.
- [] 5.4.02 - Create IA_Look.
- [] 5.4.03 - Create IA_Jump.
- [] 5.4.04 - Create IA_Sprint.
- [] 5.4.05 - Create IA_Crouch.
- [] 5.4.06 - Create IA_Interact.
- [] 5.4.07 - Create IA_HoldInteract.
- [] 5.4.08 - Create IA_Attack.
- [] 5.4.09 - Create IA_Aim.
- [] 5.4.10 - Create IA_Block.
- [] 5.4.11 - Create IA_UseItem.
- [] 5.4.12 - Create IA_DropItem.
- [] 5.4.13 - Create IA_OpenInventory.
- [] 5.4.14 - Create IA_OpenCrafting.
- [] 5.4.15 - Create IA_OpenMap.
- [] 5.4.16 - Create IA_Pause.
- [] 5.4.17 - Create IA_Hotbar_1 through IA_Hotbar_6.
- [] 5.4.18 - Create IMC_Player.
- [] 5.4.19 - Create IMC_UI.
- [] 5.4.20 - Create IMC_Inventory.
- [] 5.4.21 - Map default keyboard/mouse bindings.
- [] 5.4.22 - Commit input assets.

5.5 Collision and Gameplay Tags

- [] 5.5.01 - Create Interactable object channel.
- [] 5.5.02 - Create Pickup object channel.
- [] 5.5.03 - Create NPCSurvivor object channel.
- [] 5.5.04 - Create Wildlife object channel.
- [] 5.5.05 - Create Boundary object channel.
- [] 5.5.06 - Create Projectile object channel.
- [] 5.5.07 - Create Resource object channel.
- [] 5.5.08 - Create InteractionTrace trace channel.
- [] 5.5.09 - Create WeaponTrace trace channel.
- [] 5.5.10 - Create AIVisibilityTrace trace channel.
- [] 5.5.11 - Create gameplay tags for Item.Weapon, Item.Tool, Item.Food, Item.Water, Item.Material.
- [] 5.5.12 - Create gameplay tags for Status.Bleeding, Status.Poisoned, Status.Exhausted.
- [] 5.5.13 - Create gameplay tags for Arena.Zone.Core, Forest, Ridge, Marsh, Ruins.
- [] 5.5.14 - Create gameplay tags for Arena.Event.SupplyDrop, Weather, BoundarySurge.
- [] 5.5.15 - Commit collision/tag settings.

Phase 6 - Codex + NoGlyph AI Workflow Setup

Goal: Set safe AI rules before allowing Codex to control Unreal through NoGlyph.

PHASE GATE: Move on when the plugin is tested in a throwaway project and the real project has a locked prompt workflow.

6.1 NoGlyph Install and Test

- [] 6.1.01 - Purchase/download NoGlyph Blueprint Stack when ready.
- [] 6.1.02 - Install the plugin according to NoGlyph documentation.
- [] 6.1.03 - Open a throwaway UE 5.7 project first.
- [] 6.1.04 - Confirm NoGlyph panel/tooling appears in Unreal.
- [] 6.1.05 - Connect Codex or selected agent.
- [] 6.1.06 - Run a simple inspect/read asset command.
- [] 6.1.07 - Run a simple create variable test in a throwaway Blueprint.
- [] 6.1.08 - Run a simple material creation test.
- [] 6.1.09 - Verify the plugin does not crash the editor.
- [] 6.1.10 - Only then install/enable it in The24th project.

6.2 AI Safety Rules

- [] 6.2.01 - Create The24th_NoGlyph_Context.md.
- [] 6.2.02 - Define the rule: work only in /Game/The24th/.
- [] 6.2.03 - Define the rule: do not touch Engine content.
- [] 6.2.04 - Define the rule: do not rename/delete assets without permission.
- [] 6.2.05 - Define the rule: one system per prompt.
- [] 6.2.06 - Define the rule: summarize every change after editing.
- [] 6.2.07 - Define the rule: provide testing instructions after every edit.
- [] 6.2.08 - Define the rule: do not build unrelated systems.
- [] 6.2.09 - Define the rule: compile after changes where possible.
- [] 6.2.10 - Commit the AI context file.

6.3 Prompt Pack

- [] 6.3.01 - Create prompt for BP_SurvivalStatsComponent.
- [] 6.3.02 - Create prompt for WBP_HUD.
- [] 6.3.03 - Create prompt for BP_InteractionComponent.
- [] 6.3.04 - Create prompt for BPI_Interactable.
- [] 6.3.05 - Create prompt for BP_ItemBase and pickup flow.
- [] 6.3.06 - Create prompt for BP_InventoryComponent.
- [] 6.3.07 - Create prompt for WBP_Inventory.
- [] 6.3.08 - Create prompt for BP_HotbarComponent and WBP_Hotbar.
- [] 6.3.09 - Create prompt for BP_CraftingComponent.
- [] 6.3.10 - Create prompt for BP_CombatComponent.
- [] 6.3.11 - Create prompt for BP_TrialGameMode.
- [] 6.3.12 - Create prompt for BP_ElevatorPod.
- [] 6.3.13 - Create prompt for BP_BoundaryFieldVolume.
- [] 6.3.14 - Create prompt for BP_NPCSurvivorCharacter.
- [] 6.3.15 - Create prompt for BP_ArenaEventManager.
- [] 6.3.16 - Store prompts in The24th_NoGlyph_Prompt_Pack.md.

6.4 AI Session Checklist

- [] 6.4.01 - Pull latest Git changes before opening Unreal.
- [] 6.4.02 - Open Unreal project.
- [] 6.4.03 - Open correct test map.
- [] 6.4.04 - Open NoGlyph/agent interface.
- [] 6.4.05 - Paste short project context at session start.
- [] 6.4.06 - Give one precise task prompt.
- [] 6.4.07 - Let Codex inspect before editing.
- [] 6.4.08 - Save and compile edited assets.

- ☐ 6.4.09 - Run PIE test.
- ☐ 6.4.10 - Commit the working change.
- ☐ 6.4.11 - Write a short devlog note for the change.

Phase 7 - Player Foundation and Survival Stats

Goal: Build the player control baseline and first reusable gameplay component.

PHASE GATE: Move on when the player can move and survival stats update correctly in the HUD/test environment.

7.1 Player Character Setup

- [] 7.1.01 - Configure BP_PlayerSurvivorCharacter as the playable character.
- [] 7.1.02 - Add first-person camera if not inherited from template.
- [] 7.1.03 - Attach default mesh/arms placeholder.
- [] 7.1.04 - Add spring/camera settings if needed.
- [] 7.1.05 - Add Enhanced Input mapping context on BeginPlay.
- [] 7.1.06 - Map movement input.
- [] 7.1.07 - Map look input.
- [] 7.1.08 - Map jump input.
- [] 7.1.09 - Map sprint input.
- [] 7.1.10 - Map crouch input.
- [] 7.1.11 - Test WASD movement.
- [] 7.1.12 - Test mouse look.
- [] 7.1.13 - Test jump.
- [] 7.1.14 - Test sprint.
- [] 7.1.15 - Test crouch.
- [] 7.1.16 - Commit player foundation.

7.2 Survival Stats Component

- [] 7.2.01 - Add Health and MaxHealth variables.
- [] 7.2.02 - Add Stamina and MaxStamina variables.
- [] 7.2.03 - Add Hunger and MaxHunger variables.
- [] 7.2.04 - Add Thirst and MaxThirst variables.
- [] 7.2.05 - Add drain rate variables.
- [] 7.2.06 - Add regeneration variables.
- [] 7.2.07 - Add blsSprinting.
- [] 7.2.08 - Add blsDead.
- [] 7.2.09 - Add stat clamp logic.
- [] 7.2.10 - Add hunger drain over time.
- [] 7.2.11 - Add thirst drain over time.
- [] 7.2.12 - Add sprint stamina drain.
- [] 7.2.13 - Add stamina regeneration.
- [] 7.2.14 - Add starvation damage.
- [] 7.2.15 - Add dehydration damage.
- [] 7.2.16 - Add ApplyDamage function.
- [] 7.2.17 - Add Heal function.
- [] 7.2.18 - Add ConsumeFood function.
- [] 7.2.19 - Add DrinkWater function.
- [] 7.2.20 - Add CheckDeath function.
- [] 7.2.21 - Add OnHealthChanged dispatcher.
- [] 7.2.22 - Add OnStaminaChanged dispatcher.
- [] 7.2.23 - Add OnHungerChanged dispatcher.
- [] 7.2.24 - Add OnThirstChanged dispatcher.
- [] 7.2.25 - Add OnDeath dispatcher.
- [] 7.2.26 - Attach component to player.
- [] 7.2.27 - Test stats in Map_TestSystems.
- [] 7.2.28 - Commit survival stats component.

7.3 Minimal HUD Connection

- [] 7.3.01 - Add health progress bar to WBP_HUD.
- [] 7.3.02 - Add stamina progress bar to WBP_HUD.

- [] 7.3.03 - Add hunger progress bar to WBP_HUD.
- [] 7.3.04 - Add thirst progress bar to WBP_HUD.
- [] 7.3.05 - Add remaining Survivors placeholder text.
- [] 7.3.06 - Add zone code placeholder text.
- [] 7.3.07 - Add interaction prompt placeholder.
- [] 7.3.08 - Add event warning placeholder.
- [] 7.3.09 - Create HUD on player BeginPlay or controller BeginPlay.
- [] 7.3.10 - Bind HUD update to stat dispatchers.
- [] 7.3.11 - Test stat changes update HUD.
- [] 7.3.12 - Test HUD at different resolutions.
- [] 7.3.13 - Commit minimal HUD.

Phase 8 - Interaction, Items, Inventory, Hotbar, and Crafting

Goal: Create the basic survival object loop: look at objects, pick up items, store them, equip/use them, and craft with them.

PHASE GATE: Move on when the player can gather items, manage a small inventory, use a hotbar, and craft starter items.

8.1 Interaction System

- [] 8.1.01 - Define BPI_Interactable functions.
- [] 8.1.02 - Add GetInteractPrompt function.
- [] 8.1.03 - Add CanInteract function.
- [] 8.1.04 - Add Interact function.
- [] 8.1.05 - Add StartHoldInteract function.
- [] 8.1.06 - Add CancelHoldInteract function.
- [] 8.1.07 - Add CompleteHoldInteract function.
- [] 8.1.08 - Add line trace from camera.
- [] 8.1.09 - Set interaction distance to 300 units for prototype.
- [] 8.1.10 - Detect interactable actors.
- [] 8.1.11 - Show HUD prompt when target is valid.
- [] 8.1.12 - Hide HUD prompt when target is invalid.
- [] 8.1.13 - Map E to interact.
- [] 8.1.14 - Add hold interact placeholder.
- [] 8.1.15 - Create BP_TestInteractableCrate.
- [] 8.1.16 - Test interaction prompt.
- [] 8.1.17 - Test interact event.
- [] 8.1.18 - Commit interaction system.

8.2 Item Base and Pickups

- [] 8.2.01 - Create item base variables using ST_ItemData.
- [] 8.2.02 - Create BP_PickupItem from BP_ItemBase.
- [] 8.2.03 - Add item mesh placeholder.
- [] 8.2.04 - Add item icon placeholder.
- [] 8.2.05 - Add item quantity.
- [] 8.2.06 - Add pickup interaction.
- [] 8.2.07 - Add pickup sound placeholder.
- [] 8.2.08 - Add pickup destroy/disable after collection.
- [] 8.2.09 - Create test pickups for Wood, Stone, Fibre, Herb, Food, Water.
- [] 8.2.10 - Place pickups in Map_TestSystems.
- [] 8.2.11 - Test pickup interaction.
- [] 8.2.12 - Commit item pickup foundation.

8.3 Inventory Component

- [] 8.3.01 - Create InventorySlots array.
- [] 8.3.02 - Create MaxInventorySlots variable.
- [] 8.3.03 - Create AddItem function.
- [] 8.3.04 - Create RemoveItem function.
- [] 8.3.05 - Create DropItem function.
- [] 8.3.06 - Create UseItem function.
- [] 8.3.07 - Create MoveItem function.
- [] 8.3.08 - Create HasItem function.
- [] 8.3.09 - Create ConsumeItem function.
- [] 8.3.10 - Support stackable items.
- [] 8.3.11 - Support non-stackable items.
- [] 8.3.12 - Add OnInventoryChanged dispatcher.
- [] 8.3.13 - Attach inventory component to player.
- [] 8.3.14 - Connect pickups to AddItem.

- [] 8.3.15 - Test inventory array changes.
- [] 8.3.16 - Commit inventory component.

8.4 Inventory UI

- [] 8.4.01 - Create 5x4 inventory grid placeholder.
- [] 8.4.02 - Create inventory slot widget if needed.
- [] 8.4.03 - Display item icons.
- [] 8.4.04 - Display stack count.
- [] 8.4.05 - Display selected item details.
- [] 8.4.06 - Add Use button placeholder.
- [] 8.4.07 - Add Drop button placeholder.
- [] 8.4.08 - Map Tab to toggle inventory.
- [] 8.4.09 - Pause/adjust input mode while inventory is open.
- [] 8.4.10 - Test open/close inventory.
- [] 8.4.11 - Test item display.
- [] 8.4.12 - Commit inventory UI.

8.5 Hotbar

- [] 8.5.01 - Create HotbarSlots array.
- [] 8.5.02 - Create MaxHotbarSlots variable set to 6.
- [] 8.5.03 - Create AssignToHotbar function.
- [] 8.5.04 - Create SelectHotbarSlot function.
- [] 8.5.05 - Create UseSelectedHotbarItem function.
- [] 8.5.06 - Create WBP_Hotbar with 6 slots.
- [] 8.5.07 - Display selected slot highlight.
- [] 8.5.08 - Map number keys 1 to 6.
- [] 8.5.09 - Connect hotbar selection to current equipped item.
- [] 8.5.10 - Test assigning item to hotbar.
- [] 8.5.11 - Test hotbar selection.
- [] 8.5.12 - Commit hotbar system.

8.6 Crafting

- [] 8.6.01 - Create KnownRecipes array.
- [] 8.6.02 - Create CanCraft function.
- [] 8.6.03 - Create StartCrafting function.
- [] 8.6.04 - Create CancelCrafting function.
- [] 8.6.05 - Create CompleteCrafting function.
- [] 8.6.06 - Create ConsumeRecipeItems function.
- [] 8.6.07 - Create WBP_CraftingMenu.
- [] 8.6.08 - Display recipe list.
- [] 8.6.09 - Display required materials.
- [] 8.6.10 - Display owned material counts.
- [] 8.6.11 - Add craft button.
- [] 8.6.12 - Add crafting progress bar.
- [] 8.6.13 - Add recipes for Stone Knife, Wooden Spear, Bandage.
- [] 8.6.14 - Test successful craft.
- [] 8.6.15 - Test failed craft when materials missing.
- [] 8.6.16 - Test crafted item appears in inventory.
- [] 8.6.17 - Commit crafting system.

Phase 9 - Combat, Damage, Stealth, Status Effects, and Basic Survival Consequences

Goal: Make survival decisions matter through damage, combat risk, stealth, and injuries.

PHASE GATE: Move on when the player can fight, take damage, die, recover, and use stealth variables for future AI.

9.1 Damage and Combat Component

- [] 9.1.01 - Create CurrentWeapon variable.
- [] 9.1.02 - Create AttackDamage variable.
- [] 9.1.03 - Create HeavyAttackDamage variable.
- [] 9.1.04 - Create AttackRange variable.
- [] 9.1.05 - Create AttackCooldown variable.
- [] 9.1.06 - Create LightAttack function.
- [] 9.1.07 - Create HeavyAttack function.
- [] 9.1.08 - Create ApplyWeaponDamage function.
- [] 9.1.09 - Create CalculateDamage function.
- [] 9.1.10 - Create EquipWeapon function.
- [] 9.1.11 - Create CanPerformAttack function.
- [] 9.1.12 - Map left mouse to attack.
- [] 9.1.13 - Apply stamina cost to attack.
- [] 9.1.14 - Create BP_TestDamageDummy.
- [] 9.1.15 - Test hit detection.
- [] 9.1.16 - Test dummy receives damage.
- [] 9.1.17 - Commit combat base.

9.2 Weapons

- [] 9.2.01 - Create BP_WeaponBase.
- [] 9.2.02 - Create BP_StoneKnife.
- [] 9.2.03 - Create BP_WoodenSpear.
- [] 9.2.04 - Create BP_ShortBow placeholder.
- [] 9.2.05 - Add weapon data from DT_WeaponStats.
- [] 9.2.06 - Add equip logic for melee weapon.
- [] 9.2.07 - Add weapon mesh placeholder.
- [] 9.2.08 - Add simple swing animation placeholder.
- [] 9.2.09 - Add basic impact sound placeholder.
- [] 9.2.10 - Test weapon equip.
- [] 9.2.11 - Test weapon damage values.
- [] 9.2.12 - Commit starter weapons.

9.3 Status Effects

- [] 9.3.01 - Create bIsBleeding variable or status effect entry.
- [] 9.3.02 - Create bleeding damage over time.
- [] 9.3.03 - Create StopBleeding function.
- [] 9.3.04 - Create bIsPoisoned variable or status effect entry.
- [] 9.3.05 - Create poison damage or stamina drain over time.
- [] 9.3.06 - Create CurePoison function.
- [] 9.3.07 - Create exhausted state when stamina is too low.
- [] 9.3.08 - Create injured leg placeholder.
- [] 9.3.09 - Connect Bandage to StopBleeding.
- [] 9.3.10 - Test bleeding.
- [] 9.3.11 - Test bandage use.
- [] 9.3.12 - Commit status effects base.

9.4 Stealth and Noise

- [] 9.4.01 - Create CurrentNoiseLevel variable.

- ☐ 9.4.02 - Create VisibilityLevel variable.
- ☐ 9.4.03 - Create blsCrouching variable.
- ☐ 9.4.04 - Create blsInFoliage variable.
- ☐ 9.4.05 - Create GenerateNoise function.
- ☐ 9.4.06 - Create CalculateVisibility function.
- ☐ 9.4.07 - Reduce noise while crouching.
- ☐ 9.4.08 - Increase noise while sprinting.
- ☐ 9.4.09 - Create foliage test volume.
- ☐ 9.4.10 - Set blsInFoliage inside foliage volume.
- ☐ 9.4.11 - Test noise values changing.
- ☐ 9.4.12 - Commit stealth foundation.

Phase 10 - Arena Foundation: Elevator, Core, Boundary, Zones, Match State

Goal: Build the arena framework that makes The 24th feel like a complete match-based survival game.

PHASE GATE: Move on when the player can rise into the arena, choose loot or flee, and the match can track death/victory.

10.1 Map_TestArena Layout

- [] 10.1.01 - Create central Core placeholder.
- [] 10.1.02 - Create elevator platform markers around the Core.
- [] 10.1.03 - Create simple forest area.
- [] 10.1.04 - Create simple ridge area.
- [] 10.1.05 - Create simple water area.
- [] 10.1.06 - Create boundary ring placeholder.
- [] 10.1.07 - Create NPC spawn markers.
- [] 10.1.08 - Create supply drop marker.
- [] 10.1.09 - Add NavMeshBoundsVolume.
- [] 10.1.10 - Press P to verify green navmesh.
- [] 10.1.11 - Add test lighting.
- [] 10.1.12 - Save and commit Map_TestArena.

10.2 Elevator Intro

- [] 10.2.01 - Create BP_ElevatorPod mesh placeholder.
- [] 10.2.02 - Place player start inside elevator.
- [] 10.2.03 - Add countdown variable.
- [] 10.2.04 - Add start sequence event.
- [] 10.2.05 - Add vertical movement timeline.
- [] 10.2.06 - Lock player movement during ascent if needed.
- [] 10.2.07 - Fade from dark to arena light.
- [] 10.2.08 - Trigger match start after elevator reaches top.
- [] 10.2.09 - Add test audio placeholder.
- [] 10.2.10 - Test full elevator intro.
- [] 10.2.11 - Commit elevator intro.

10.3 The Core

- [] 10.3.01 - Create BP_CoreSupplyCrate.
- [] 10.3.02 - Add loot table reference.
- [] 10.3.03 - Add interactable crate logic.
- [] 10.3.04 - Place multiple Core crates.
- [] 10.3.05 - Add high-risk loot values.
- [] 10.3.06 - Add visual placeholder for Core tower/platform.
- [] 10.3.07 - Add early-game loot cluster.
- [] 10.3.08 - Test looting Core crates.
- [] 10.3.09 - Add Core zone label.
- [] 10.3.10 - Commit Core prototype.

10.4 Boundary Field

- [] 10.4.01 - Create BP_BoundaryFieldVolume.
- [] 10.4.02 - Add warning distance.
- [] 10.4.03 - Add damage distance.
- [] 10.4.04 - Add kill distance placeholder if needed.
- [] 10.4.05 - Add BoundaryDamagePerSecond.
- [] 10.4.06 - Add HUD warning trigger.
- [] 10.4.07 - Add screen/audio warning placeholder.
- [] 10.4.08 - Add damage over time when too close.
- [] 10.4.09 - Test entering warning zone.

- [] 10.4.10 - Test boundary damage.
- [] 10.4.11 - Commit Boundary Field prototype.

10.5 Trial GameMode and Match State

- [] 10.5.01 - Create total Survivors variable.
- [] 10.5.02 - Create remaining Survivors variable.
- [] 10.5.03 - Create MatchPhase variable.
- [] 10.5.04 - Create StartTrial function.
- [] 10.5.05 - Create RegisterSurvivorDeath function.
- [] 10.5.06 - Create CheckVictoryCondition function.
- [] 10.5.07 - Trigger death screen when player dies.
- [] 10.5.08 - Trigger victory when one Survivor remains.
- [] 10.5.09 - Update HUD survivor count.
- [] 10.5.10 - Test manual NPC death updates.
- [] 10.5.11 - Commit match state system.

Phase 11 - NPC Survivor AI Prototype

Goal: Turn static enemies into competing Survivors with basic archetypes and goals.

PHASE GATE: Move on when at least 3 NPC Survivors can spawn, move, fight, flee, die, and affect the match count.

11.1 NPC Character Foundation

- [] 11.1.01 - Configure BP_NPCSurvivorCharacter.
- [] 11.1.02 - Add basic capsule/mesh placeholder.
- [] 11.1.03 - Add SurvivalStatsComponent.
- [] 11.1.04 - Add CombatComponent.
- [] 11.1.05 - Add InventoryComponent placeholder.
- [] 11.1.06 - Add SurvivorID variable.
- [] 11.1.07 - Add SurvivorName variable.
- [] 11.1.08 - Add Archetype variable.
- [] 11.1.09 - Add bIsAlive variable.
- [] 11.1.10 - Add death event.
- [] 11.1.11 - Test NPC can take damage.
- [] 11.1.12 - Test NPC death event.
- [] 11.1.13 - Commit NPC foundation.

11.2 AI Controller, Blackboard, Behaviour Tree

- [] 11.2.01 - Create BP_NPCSurvivorController.
- [] 11.2.02 - Create BB_NPCSurvivor.
- [] 11.2.03 - Create BT_NPCSurvivor.
- [] 11.2.04 - Add TargetActor key.
- [] 11.2.05 - Add TargetLocation key.
- [] 11.2.06 - Add CurrentGoal key.
- [] 11.2.07 - Add ThreatActor key.
- [] 11.2.08 - Add LastNoiseLocation key.
- [] 11.2.09 - Add IsHungry key.
- [] 11.2.10 - Add IsThirsty key.
- [] 11.2.11 - Add IsInjured key.
- [] 11.2.12 - Add HasWeapon key.
- [] 11.2.13 - Add ShouldFlee key.
- [] 11.2.14 - Assign AI controller to NPC.
- [] 11.2.15 - Run behaviour tree on BeginPlay.
- [] 11.2.16 - Commit AI base.

11.3 Basic NPC Behaviour

- [] 11.3.01 - Add idle/wander behaviour.
- [] 11.3.02 - Add patrol to random point behaviour.
- [] 11.3.03 - Add player detection placeholder.
- [] 11.3.04 - Add chase target behaviour.
- [] 11.3.05 - Add attack target behaviour.
- [] 11.3.06 - Add flee behaviour when low health.
- [] 11.3.07 - Add investigate noise placeholder.
- [] 11.3.08 - Add basic cooldowns.
- [] 11.3.09 - Test NPC wandering.
- [] 11.3.10 - Test NPC chasing player.
- [] 11.3.11 - Test NPC attacking player.
- [] 11.3.12 - Test NPC fleeing.
- [] 11.3.13 - Commit basic AI behaviours.

11.4 Opening Strategies and Archetypes

- [] 11.4.01 - Create ChooseStartingStrategy function.
- [] 11.4.02 - Aggressor rushes Core.

- [] 11.4.03 - Runner flees Core.
- [] 11.4.04 - Coward hides early.
- [] 11.4.05 - Hunter moves toward forest/cover.
- [] 11.4.06 - Scavenger searches loot locations.
- [] 11.4.07 - Add simple archetype tuning values.
- [] 11.4.08 - Spawn 3-5 NPCs with different archetypes.
- [] 11.4.09 - Test varied opening movement.
- [] 11.4.10 - Commit archetype opening strategies.

11.5 NPC vs NPC Combat

- [] 11.5.01 - Allow NPCs to detect other NPC Survivors.
- [] 11.5.02 - Allow NPCs to select NPC targets.
- [] 11.5.03 - Allow NPC melee damage against NPCs.
- [] 11.5.04 - Register NPC death with GameMode.
- [] 11.5.05 - Update Survivor count when NPC dies.
- [] 11.5.06 - Prevent dead NPCs from continuing behaviour tree actions.
- [] 11.5.07 - Add death loot placeholder.
- [] 11.5.08 - Test NPC eliminates NPC.
- [] 11.5.09 - Test survivor count updates.
- [] 11.5.10 - Commit NPC vs NPC combat.

Phase 12 - Arena Events, Supply Drops, Weather, Wildlife, Harvesting

Goal: Add replayability and survival pressure beyond basic combat.

PHASE GATE: Move on when at least one supply drop, one danger/weather event, and one harvest/hunt loop work.

12.1 Arena Event Manager

- [] 12.1.01 - Create ActiveEvent variable.
- [] 12.1.02 - Create EventQueue placeholder.
- [] 12.1.03 - Create EventFrequencyMin variable.
- [] 12.1.04 - Create EventFrequencyMax variable.
- [] 12.1.05 - Create MatchPhase reference.
- [] 12.1.06 - Create StartEventTimer function.
- [] 12.1.07 - Create ChooseRandomEvent function.
- [] 12.1.08 - Create BroadcastEventWarning function.
- [] 12.1.09 - Create ActivateEvent function.
- [] 12.1.10 - Create EndActiveEvent function.
- [] 12.1.11 - Create ForceEvent debug function.
- [] 12.1.12 - Connect event warning to HUD.
- [] 12.1.13 - Test manual event trigger.
- [] 12.1.14 - Commit event manager stub.

12.2 Supply Drop Event

- [] 12.2.01 - Create BP_SupplyDropPod.
- [] 12.2.02 - Add drop marker location.
- [] 12.2.03 - Add landing visual placeholder.
- [] 12.2.04 - Add landing audio placeholder.
- [] 12.2.05 - Add loot container component/logic.
- [] 12.2.06 - Add rare loot table.
- [] 12.2.07 - Add HUD warning text.
- [] 12.2.08 - Spawn drop via Event Manager.
- [] 12.2.09 - Test player can loot supply drop.
- [] 12.2.10 - Test NPC interest placeholder if available.
- [] 12.2.11 - Commit supply drop event.

12.3 Weather/Danger Event

- [] 12.3.01 - Create fog event.
- [] 12.3.02 - Reduce visibility during fog.
- [] 12.3.03 - Change ambience during fog.
- [] 12.3.04 - Create danger zone volume.
- [] 12.3.05 - Add warning before activation.
- [] 12.3.06 - Add damage over time.
- [] 12.3.07 - Add zone marker placeholder.
- [] 12.3.08 - Test entering danger zone.
- [] 12.3.09 - Test event ends correctly.
- [] 12.3.10 - Commit weather/danger event.

12.4 Harvesting

- [] 12.4.01 - Create BP_HarvestableResource.
- [] 12.4.02 - Create branch/wood pickup source.
- [] 12.4.03 - Create stone source.
- [] 12.4.04 - Create fibre plant source.
- [] 12.4.05 - Create herb plant source.
- [] 12.4.06 - Add hold interaction for harvesting.
- [] 12.4.07 - Add resource yield values.

- [] 12.4.08 - Add tool requirement placeholder.
- [] 12.4.09 - Test gathering wood/stone/fibre/herb.
- [] 12.4.10 - Test materials appear in inventory.
- [] 12.4.11 - Commit harvesting system.

12.5 Wildlife Prototype

- [] 12.5.01 - Create BP_WildlifeBase.
- [] 12.5.02 - Create BP_PreyAnimalBase.
- [] 12.5.03 - Create simple wander behaviour.
- [] 12.5.04 - Create flee from player behaviour.
- [] 12.5.05 - Create health/damage for prey.
- [] 12.5.06 - Create animal carcass actor.
- [] 12.5.07 - Add meat/hide/bone loot placeholder.
- [] 12.5.08 - Test killing prey animal.
- [] 12.5.09 - Test harvesting carcass.
- [] 12.5.10 - Commit wildlife prototype.

Phase 13 - UI, Menus, UX, Accessibility, and Frontend Flow

Goal: Turn systems into something players can understand and navigate.

PHASE GATE: Move on when the player can start, pause, change settings, read HUD info, die, win, and restart cleanly.

13.1 Main Menu

- [] 13.1.01 - Create main menu layout mockup.
- [] 13.1.02 - Build WBP_MainMenu visual shell.
- [] 13.1.03 - Add Start Trial button.
- [] 13.1.04 - Add Settings button.
- [] 13.1.05 - Add Credits button placeholder.
- [] 13.1.06 - Add Quit button.
- [] 13.1.07 - Set Map_MainMenu as future Game Default Map.
- [] 13.1.08 - Connect Start Trial to load test arena/prototype dome.
- [] 13.1.09 - Test menu navigation.
- [] 13.1.10 - Commit main menu.

13.2 Pause and Settings

- [] 13.2.01 - Build WBP_PauseMenu.
- [] 13.2.02 - Add Resume button.
- [] 13.2.03 - Add Restart Trial button placeholder.
- [] 13.2.04 - Add Settings button.
- [] 13.2.05 - Add Exit to Main Menu button.
- [] 13.2.06 - Build WBP_SettingsMenu.
- [] 13.2.07 - Add audio volume sliders.
- [] 13.2.08 - Add mouse sensitivity setting.
- [] 13.2.09 - Add graphics quality placeholder.
- [] 13.2.10 - Add subtitle toggle placeholder.
- [] 13.2.11 - Test pause/unpause.
- [] 13.2.12 - Commit pause/settings menus.

13.3 HUD Polish

- [] 13.3.01 - Add Arena Telemetry title/style.
- [] 13.3.02 - Add icon placeholders for health/stamina/hunger/thirst.
- [] 13.3.03 - Add Survivor count styling.
- [] 13.3.04 - Add zone code styling.
- [] 13.3.05 - Add event warning animation placeholder.
- [] 13.3.06 - Add low health warning.
- [] 13.3.07 - Add low stamina warning.
- [] 13.3.08 - Add low hunger/thirst warning.
- [] 13.3.09 - Test HUD at 1080p.
- [] 13.3.10 - Test HUD at 1440p if possible.
- [] 13.3.11 - Commit HUD polish.

13.4 Death and Victory Screens

- [] 13.4.01 - Build WBP_DeathScreen.
- [] 13.4.02 - Show killer/source placeholder.
- [] 13.4.03 - Show survival time placeholder.
- [] 13.4.04 - Show remaining Survivors placeholder.
- [] 13.4.05 - Add Restart Trial button.
- [] 13.4.06 - Add Return to Menu button.
- [] 13.4.07 - Build WBP_VictoryScreen.
- [] 13.4.08 - Show Ascendant confirmed message.
- [] 13.4.09 - Show stats summary.

- ☐ 13.4.10 - Test death screen.
- ☐ 13.4.11 - Test victory screen.
- ☐ 13.4.12 - Commit end-state screens.

13.5 Accessibility Basics

- ☐ 13.5.01 - Add subtitle setting placeholder.
- ☐ 13.5.02 - Add screen shake setting placeholder.
- ☐ 13.5.03 - Add motion blur setting placeholder.
- ☐ 13.5.04 - Add mouse sensitivity setting.
- ☐ 13.5.05 - Add field-of-view setting if supported.
- ☐ 13.5.06 - Avoid tiny text in HUD.
- ☐ 13.5.07 - Ensure critical warnings use text and audio, not color only.
- ☐ 13.5.08 - Add photosensitivity warning screen later.
- ☐ 13.5.09 - Test basic controller input later if needed.
- ☐ 13.5.10 - Commit accessibility basics.

Phase 14 - Art, Environment, Audio, and Content Production

Goal: Replace placeholders with coherent art/audio without breaking the systems.

PHASE GATE: Move on when the prototype has a consistent look, readable environment, and enough audio feedback to playtest properly.

14.1 Visual Style Foundation

- ☐ 14.1.01 - Create moodboard for Dome, Core, Boundary, forest, ridge, marsh, ruins.
- ☐ 14.1.02 - Define stylized-realistic art direction.
- ☐ 14.1.03 - Define color palette for UI and environment.
- ☐ 14.1.04 - Create placeholder material library.
- ☐ 14.1.05 - Create final material naming convention.
- ☐ 14.1.06 - Choose early environment asset pack if used.
- ☐ 14.1.07 - Verify asset license allows commercial use.
- ☐ 14.1.08 - Document asset sources.
- ☐ 14.1.09 - Commit art direction notes.
- ☐ 14.1.10 - Avoid overproducing art before mechanics are fun.

14.2 Arena Environment Pass

- ☐ 14.2.01 - Block out The Core Ring.
- ☐ 14.2.02 - Block out Pine Belt.
- ☐ 14.2.03 - Block out Dry Ridge.
- ☐ 14.2.04 - Block out Marsh Hollow.
- ☐ 14.2.05 - Block out Ruins zone placeholder.
- ☐ 14.2.06 - Block out Boundary Verge.
- ☐ 14.2.07 - Add landmarks for orientation.
- ☐ 14.2.08 - Add cover/hiding areas.
- ☐ 14.2.09 - Add resource clusters.
- ☐ 14.2.10 - Add water source locations.
- ☐ 14.2.11 - Add NPC pathing routes.
- ☐ 14.2.12 - Test navigation flow.
- ☐ 14.2.13 - Commit arena blackout.

14.3 Player and NPC Visuals

- ☐ 14.3.01 - Choose placeholder player arms/body setup.
- ☐ 14.3.02 - Choose placeholder NPC mesh.
- ☐ 14.3.03 - Create simple Survivor outfit variations.
- ☐ 14.3.04 - Create color/gear variation plan for archetypes.
- ☐ 14.3.05 - Add basic first-person hands if needed.
- ☐ 14.3.06 - Add basic melee animation placeholder.
- ☐ 14.3.07 - Add basic bow animation placeholder later.
- ☐ 14.3.08 - Add NPC locomotion animations.
- ☐ 14.3.09 - Add hit reaction placeholder.
- ☐ 14.3.10 - Commit character visual pass.

14.4 Audio

- ☐ 14.4.01 - Create SFX folder structure.
- ☐ 14.4.02 - Add placeholder UI click sounds.
- ☐ 14.4.03 - Add footstep placeholder sounds.
- ☐ 14.4.04 - Add pickup sound.
- ☐ 14.4.05 - Add inventory open/close sound.
- ☐ 14.4.06 - Add crafting start/complete sounds.
- ☐ 14.4.07 - Add melee swing/hit sounds.
- ☐ 14.4.08 - Add Boundary Field hum placeholder.

- [] 14.4.09 - Add elevator movement sound.
- [] 14.4.10 - Add Operator broadcast placeholders.
- [] 14.4.11 - Add forest ambience.
- [] 14.4.12 - Add danger event ambience.
- [] 14.4.13 - Test audio mix roughly.
- [] 14.4.14 - Commit audio placeholders.

14.5 Content Licensing

- [] 14.5.01 - Create Asset_Licenses.md.
- [] 14.5.02 - Log every marketplace/free asset used.
- [] 14.5.03 - Log creator/source link.
- [] 14.5.04 - Log license type.
- [] 14.5.05 - Log whether asset allows commercial use.
- [] 14.5.06 - Log whether attribution is required.
- [] 14.5.07 - Store receipts/screenshots where appropriate.
- [] 14.5.08 - Avoid unclear music/SFX licenses.
- [] 14.5.09 - Avoid copyrighted franchise references in art.
- [] 14.5.10 - Review licenses before Steam store assets are finalized.

Phase 15 - Vertical Slice, Alpha, and Beta Production Gates

Goal: Turn the prototype into a representative, playable slice and then a content-complete build.

PHASE GATE: Move on when the game has one complete match that communicates the intended experience.

15.1 Vertical Slice Must-Haves

- ☐ 15.1.01 - Elevator intro works from start.
- ☐ 15.1.02 - The Core contains loot.
- ☐ 15.1.03 - At least 8-12 NPC Survivors can spawn.
- ☐ 15.1.04 - Survival stats matter.
- ☐ 15.1.05 - Inventory and hotbar work.
- ☐ 15.1.06 - At least 5 items exist.
- ☐ 15.1.07 - At least 3 craftable recipes exist.
- ☐ 15.1.08 - Basic melee combat works.
- ☐ 15.1.09 - At least one arena event works.
- ☐ 15.1.10 - Boundary Field works.
- ☐ 15.1.11 - Death and victory screens work.
- ☐ 15.1.12 - Match can restart.
- ☐ 15.1.13 - Commit vertical slice candidate.

15.2 Internal Playtest Pass

- ☐ 15.2.01 - Play 5 full matches yourself.
- ☐ 15.2.02 - Record every bug in GitHub Issues.
- ☐ 15.2.03 - Record every confusing UI moment.
- ☐ 15.2.04 - Record every balance problem.
- ☐ 15.2.05 - Record every crash or soft-lock.
- ☐ 15.2.06 - Fix critical bugs first.
- ☐ 15.2.07 - Fix blocker bugs before adding content.
- ☐ 15.2.08 - Create playtest feedback form.
- ☐ 15.2.09 - Invite 1-3 trusted testers.
- ☐ 15.2.10 - Collect feedback.
- ☐ 15.2.11 - Commit playtest fixes.

15.3 Alpha Gate

- ☐ 15.3.01 - All major planned prototype systems exist.
- ☐ 15.3.02 - The game can be played from menu to ending.
- ☐ 15.3.03 - No known crash on normal flow.
- ☐ 15.3.04 - NPCs produce basic match variety.
- ☐ 15.3.05 - Arena layout is readable.
- ☐ 15.3.06 - Main UI is functional.
- ☐ 15.3.07 - Settings/pause work.
- ☐ 15.3.08 - Packaged development build runs on your PC.
- ☐ 15.3.09 - Known issues list exists.
- ☐ 15.3.10 - Commit alpha build.

15.4 Beta Gate

- ☐ 15.4.01 - All Early Access launch systems are content-complete.
- ☐ 15.4.02 - Placeholder assets are replaced where players will judge quality.
- ☐ 15.4.03 - Performance target is met on your PC.
- ☐ 15.4.04 - External testers can complete a match.
- ☐ 15.4.05 - Major bugs are fixed or documented.
- ☐ 15.4.06 - Steam page assets are in progress.
- ☐ 15.4.07 - Trailer capture build is ready.
- ☐ 15.4.08 - Pricing/launch approach is decided.

- ☐ 15.4.09 - Commit beta candidate.
- ☐ 15.4.10 - Create beta release notes.

Phase 16 - QA, Optimization, Packaging, and Build Discipline

Goal: Make the game stable enough for outside players and Steam review.

PHASE GATE: Move on when a clean Windows Shipping build packages reliably and passes your smoke test.

16.1 QA Checklist

- ☐ 16.1.01 - Create QA_TestPlan.md.
- ☐ 16.1.02 - Create smoke test checklist.
- ☐ 16.1.03 - Create new game test.
- ☐ 16.1.04 - Create settings test.
- ☐ 16.1.05 - Create input test.
- ☐ 16.1.06 - Create inventory test.
- ☐ 16.1.07 - Create crafting test.
- ☐ 16.1.08 - Create combat test.
- ☐ 16.1.09 - Create NPC test.
- ☐ 16.1.10 - Create arena event test.
- ☐ 16.1.11 - Create victory test.
- ☐ 16.1.12 - Create death/restart test.
- ☐ 16.1.13 - Create packaged build test.
- ☐ 16.1.14 - Run smoke test after every release candidate.

16.2 Optimization

- ☐ 16.2.01 - Measure FPS in Map_TestArena.
- ☐ 16.2.02 - Measure FPS in Map_PrototypeDome.
- ☐ 16.2.03 - Profile CPU frame time.
- ☐ 16.2.04 - Profile GPU frame time.
- ☐ 16.2.05 - Check draw calls.
- ☐ 16.2.06 - Check expensive lights/shadows.
- ☐ 16.2.07 - Check Nanite usage if applicable.
- ☐ 16.2.08 - Check Lumen/global illumination settings.
- ☐ 16.2.09 - Check foliage density.
- ☐ 16.2.10 - Check AI tick/update frequency.
- ☐ 16.2.11 - Optimize UI tick/bindings.
- ☐ 16.2.12 - Reduce unnecessary Event Tick usage.
- ☐ 16.2.13 - Create performance settings presets.
- ☐ 16.2.14 - Commit optimization pass.

16.3 Packaging Setup

- ☐ 16.3.01 - Set build configuration to Shipping for release candidates.
- ☐ 16.3.02 - Set target platform to Windows.
- ☐ 16.3.03 - Review packaging settings.
- ☐ 16.3.04 - Set project version number.
- ☐ 16.3.05 - Set company/product name placeholders.
- ☐ 16.3.06 - Check maps included in packaging.
- ☐ 16.3.07 - Check default map loads correctly.
- ☐ 16.3.08 - Package a Development build first.
- ☐ 16.3.09 - Package a Shipping build after Development build works.
- ☐ 16.3.10 - Run packaged executable.
- ☐ 16.3.11 - Test packaged build menu.
- ☐ 16.3.12 - Test packaged build full match.
- ☐ 16.3.13 - Record package errors.
- ☐ 16.3.14 - Fix package errors before Steam upload.

16.4 Build Versioning

- [] 16.4.01 - Create version format: 0.0.1-prototype, 0.1.0-alpha, 0.2.0-beta.
- [] 16.4.02 - Add version number to main menu or credits.
- [] 16.4.03 - Add build date display for test builds.
- [] 16.4.04 - Create changelog file.
- [] 16.4.05 - Tag major Git milestones.
- [] 16.4.06 - Archive packaged builds by version.
- [] 16.4.07 - Do not overwrite old release candidate builds.
- [] 16.4.08 - Create a release notes template.
- [] 16.4.09 - Commit version metadata changes.
- [] 16.4.10 - Tag first vertical slice build.

Phase 17 - Steamworks Onboarding and Store Preparation

Goal: Prepare the business and Steam account side while the game is still being developed.

PHASE GATE: Move on when Steamworks access, app fee, app ID, tax/bank info, and store checklist are ready.

17.1 Steamworks Account

- [] 17.1.01 - Sign in to Steamworks with the correct Steam account.
- [] 17.1.02 - Enable Steam Guard/2FA.
- [] 17.1.03 - Complete legal identity/company information.
- [] 17.1.04 - Confirm the legal name matches the publishing rights holder.
- [] 17.1.05 - Complete tax interview/forms.
- [] 17.1.06 - Enter bank/payment details.
- [] 17.1.07 - Confirm the bank can receive USD SWIFT wire payments.
- [] 17.1.08 - Read Steam Distribution Agreement carefully.
- [] 17.1.09 - Save business/legal notes securely.
- [] 17.1.10 - Wait for account approval if required.

17.2 Steam Direct Fee and App ID

- [] 17.2.01 - Budget the Steam Direct/Product Submission Fee.
- [] 17.2.02 - Pay the product submission fee for The 24th when ready.
- [] 17.2.03 - Create the new Steam app.
- [] 17.2.04 - Record the App ID in project docs.
- [] 17.2.05 - Create Steamworks_Admin.md with important links and IDs.
- [] 17.2.06 - Do not expose private Steamworks details publicly.
- [] 17.2.07 - Create Steamworks checklist issue in GitHub.
- [] 17.2.08 - Assign Steam tasks to a Steam milestone.
- [] 17.2.09 - Review fee recoupment rules.
- [] 17.2.10 - Confirm the app appears in Steamworks dashboard.

17.3 Steam Page Strategy

- [] 17.3.01 - Decide whether launch will be Early Access or full release.
- [] 17.3.02 - Write one-line short description.
- [] 17.3.03 - Write long description draft.
- [] 17.3.04 - Write key feature bullets.
- [] 17.3.05 - Define player promise clearly.
- [] 17.3.06 - Define what content exists at Early Access launch.
- [] 17.3.07 - Define what is planned post-launch.
- [] 17.3.08 - Draft Early Access Q&A; if applicable.
- [] 17.3.09 - Choose primary genre/category tags.
- [] 17.3.10 - Choose supported languages for launch.
- [] 17.3.11 - Create store copy review checklist.

17.4 Steam Graphical Assets

- [] 17.4.01 - Create Header Capsule 920x430.
- [] 17.4.02 - Create Small Capsule 462x174.
- [] 17.4.03 - Create Main Capsule 1232x706.
- [] 17.4.04 - Create Vertical Capsule 748x896.
- [] 17.4.05 - Create Screenshots at minimum 1920x1080 16:9.
- [] 17.4.06 - Create Shortcut Icon 256x256.
- [] 17.4.07 - Create App Icon 184x184 jpg.
- [] 17.4.08 - Create Library Capsule 600x900.
- [] 17.4.09 - Create Library Hero 3840x1240 png.
- [] 17.4.10 - Create Library Logo as transparent png.
- [] 17.4.11 - Ensure capsule logo/name is readable.

- [] 17.4.12 - Ensure capsule artwork is PG-13 appropriate.
- [] 17.4.13 - Export assets in required formats.
- [] 17.4.14 - Store source files in Marketing/Steam_Assets.

17.5 Trailer and Screenshots

- [] 17.5.01 - Plan first announcement trailer.
- [] 17.5.02 - Capture elevator intro shot.
- [] 17.5.03 - Capture Core rush shot.
- [] 17.5.04 - Capture survival/crafting shot.
- [] 17.5.05 - Capture NPC encounter shot.
- [] 17.5.06 - Capture Boundary Field shot.
- [] 17.5.07 - Capture UI screenshot.
- [] 17.5.08 - Avoid misleading screenshots not representative of gameplay.
- [] 17.5.09 - Edit trailer to show actual gameplay.
- [] 17.5.10 - Create trailer captions/subtitles if needed.
- [] 17.5.11 - Export trailer in Steam-compatible format.
- [] 17.5.12 - Prepare YouTube version of trailer.

Phase 18 - SteamPipe Builds, Depots, Branches, and Review

Goal: Upload a correct build to Steam and pass Valve review before release.

PHASE GATE: Move on when the store page is approved, the build is approved, and the Coming Soon period/release timing is satisfied.

18.1 Steamworks App Configuration

- [] 18.1.01 - Set app name.
- [] 18.1.02 - Set supported operating systems.
- [] 18.1.03 - Create default package if needed.
- [] 18.1.04 - Configure launch options for Windows executable.
- [] 18.1.05 - Configure required redistributables if needed.
- [] 18.1.06 - Configure basic achievements later if planned.
- [] 18.1.07 - Configure cloud saves later only if implemented.
- [] 18.1.08 - Configure controller support fields accurately.
- [] 18.1.09 - Configure language support accurately.
- [] 18.1.10 - Save Steamworks app configuration.

18.2 Depots and SteamPipe

- [] 18.2.01 - Download Steamworks SDK.
- [] 18.2.02 - Create content builder folder outside the repo.
- [] 18.2.03 - Create app build script.
- [] 18.2.04 - Create depot build script.
- [] 18.2.05 - Assign Windows depot.
- [] 18.2.06 - Point depot content path to packaged build folder.
- [] 18.2.07 - Exclude debug/unneeded files.
- [] 18.2.08 - Run SteamCMD login/upload test.
- [] 18.2.09 - Upload first private build.
- [] 18.2.10 - Verify build appears in Steamworks Builds page.
- [] 18.2.11 - Set build to a private beta branch first.
- [] 18.2.12 - Test install through Steam client if possible.

18.3 Store Review

- [] 18.3.01 - Complete all required store presence fields.
- [] 18.3.02 - Upload all required graphical assets.
- [] 18.3.03 - Upload required screenshots.
- [] 18.3.04 - Upload trailer if ready.
- [] 18.3.05 - Set accurate tags/genres.
- [] 18.3.06 - Set content descriptors accurately.
- [] 18.3.07 - Set supported languages accurately.
- [] 18.3.08 - Complete Early Access questionnaire if applicable.
- [] 18.3.09 - Preview store page.
- [] 18.3.10 - Fix visible grammar/art errors.
- [] 18.3.11 - Submit store page for review at least 7 business days before desired visibility date.
- [] 18.3.12 - Respond to Valve feedback.
- [] 18.3.13 - Resubmit if required.
- [] 18.3.14 - Wait for Ready for Release status.

18.4 Build Review

- [] 18.4.01 - Upload release candidate build.
- [] 18.4.02 - Set correct default branch/build for review.
- [] 18.4.03 - Verify executable launches from Steam.
- [] 18.4.04 - Verify no missing DLLs or cooked assets.
- [] 18.4.05 - Verify menu and start flow work.

- ☐ 18.4.06 - Verify controls work.
- ☐ 18.4.07 - Verify no malicious/irrelevant files included.
- ☐ 18.4.08 - Verify store description matches actual build.
- ☐ 18.4.09 - Submit build for review.
- ☐ 18.4.10 - Respond to Valve feedback.
- ☐ 18.4.11 - Resubmit if required.
- ☐ 18.4.12 - Wait for build approval.

18.5 Coming Soon

- ☐ 18.5.01 - Post store page as Coming Soon after approval.
- ☐ 18.5.02 - Confirm Coming Soon page is publicly visible.
- ☐ 18.5.03 - Share Steam page on YouTube/community posts.
- ☐ 18.5.04 - Encourage wishlists naturally.
- ☐ 18.5.05 - Keep screenshots/trailer updated if major improvements are made.
- ☐ 18.5.06 - Track wishlist count.
- ☐ 18.5.07 - Maintain devlog cadence during Coming Soon period.
- ☐ 18.5.08 - Do not promise features that are not planned/realistic.
- ☐ 18.5.09 - Ensure Coming Soon page is live for at least required minimum period before release.
- ☐ 18.5.10 - Prepare launch build while Coming Soon is live.

Phase 19 - Launch Readiness and Launch Day

Goal: Release the game in a controlled, prepared, and recoverable way.

PHASE GATE: Move on only when release candidate, Steam page, launch copy, support channels, and rollback/fix plan are ready.

19.1 Release Candidate Lock

- ☐ 19.1.01 - Choose final launch candidate build.
- ☐ 19.1.02 - Tag launch candidate in Git.
- ☐ 19.1.03 - Archive launch candidate locally.
- ☐ 19.1.04 - Upload launch candidate to Steam.
- ☐ 19.1.05 - Set launch candidate as default build only when approved/ready.
- ☐ 19.1.06 - Run full smoke test from Steam install.
- ☐ 19.1.07 - Check main menu version number.
- ☐ 19.1.08 - Check save/settings behavior.
- ☐ 19.1.09 - Check first match flow.
- ☐ 19.1.10 - Check death/victory flow.
- ☐ 19.1.11 - Fix only critical issues after RC lock.
- ☐ 19.1.12 - Document known issues honestly.

19.2 Launch Marketing Prep

- ☐ 19.2.01 - Prepare YouTube launch video.
- ☐ 19.2.02 - Prepare launch trailer upload.
- ☐ 19.2.03 - Prepare YouTube Shorts clips.
- ☐ 19.2.04 - Prepare community post.
- ☐ 19.2.05 - Prepare Discord announcement if applicable.
- ☐ 19.2.06 - Prepare Steam announcement post.
- ☐ 19.2.07 - Prepare press kit folder.
- ☐ 19.2.08 - Prepare screenshots for social posts.
- ☐ 19.2.09 - Prepare FAQ for players.
- ☐ 19.2.10 - Prepare bug report instructions.
- ☐ 19.2.11 - Prepare launch day schedule.
- ☐ 19.2.12 - Prepare post-launch hotfix time window.

19.3 Steam Release

- ☐ 19.3.01 - Double-check pricing/discount settings.
- ☐ 19.3.02 - Double-check Early Access status if applicable.
- ☐ 19.3.03 - Double-check store assets.
- ☐ 19.3.04 - Double-check default branch/build.
- ☐ 19.3.05 - Double-check release checklist completion.
- ☐ 19.3.06 - Use Steam Release App button when ready.
- ☐ 19.3.07 - Confirm store page shows purchase/install correctly.
- ☐ 19.3.08 - Install game from public store account if possible.
- ☐ 19.3.09 - Test public install launches.
- ☐ 19.3.10 - Post launch announcement.
- ☐ 19.3.11 - Post YouTube/community updates.
- ☐ 19.3.12 - Monitor Steam discussion/community hub.

19.4 Launch Day Monitoring

- ☐ 19.4.01 - Watch for crash reports or common blockers.
- ☐ 19.4.02 - Monitor Steam reviews carefully but calmly.
- ☐ 19.4.03 - Monitor YouTube comments.
- ☐ 19.4.04 - Monitor Discord/community feedback.
- ☐ 19.4.05 - Log every reported bug in GitHub Issues.
- ☐ 19.4.06 - Prioritize crash/blocker fixes first.
- ☐ 19.4.07 - Avoid emotional replies to criticism.

- ☐ 19.4.08 - Thank players who report bugs.
- ☐ 19.4.09 - Prepare hotfix build if needed.
- ☐ 19.4.10 - Post status update if severe issue appears.

Phase 20 - Post-Launch, Hotfixes, Early Access, and Long-Term Support

Goal: Support the game after release and use player feedback to improve it safely.

PHASE GATE: Checklist is complete when the game is launched, supported, patched, and managed with a clear update pipeline.

20.1 First Week Support

- [] 20.1.01 - Triage all launch bugs.
- [] 20.1.02 - Fix crashes first.
- [] 20.1.03 - Fix progression blockers second.
- [] 20.1.04 - Fix major balance issues third.
- [] 20.1.05 - Create hotfix branch.
- [] 20.1.06 - Package hotfix build.
- [] 20.1.07 - Upload hotfix to Steam private branch.
- [] 20.1.08 - Test hotfix from Steam install.
- [] 20.1.09 - Promote hotfix to default branch.
- [] 20.1.10 - Post patch notes.
- [] 20.1.11 - Thank players for reports.
- [] 20.1.12 - Update known issues list.

20.2 Patch Pipeline

- [] 20.2.01 - Create patch version numbering rules.
- [] 20.2.02 - Create changelog format.
- [] 20.2.03 - Create testing checklist for every patch.
- [] 20.2.04 - Create beta branch for testers.
- [] 20.2.05 - Do not patch directly to default without testing.
- [] 20.2.06 - Archive every public build.
- [] 20.2.07 - Tag every release in Git.
- [] 20.2.08 - Keep Steam announcements short and clear.
- [] 20.2.09 - Update store page if features significantly change.
- [] 20.2.10 - Track feedback by category.

20.3 Early Access Roadmap

- [] 20.3.01 - Publish only realistic roadmap items.
- [] 20.3.02 - Separate confirmed features from ideas.
- [] 20.3.03 - Define next major update.
- [] 20.3.04 - Define next AI improvement milestone.
- [] 20.3.05 - Define next arena content milestone.
- [] 20.3.06 - Define next UI/accessibility milestone.
- [] 20.3.07 - Define performance target milestone.
- [] 20.3.08 - Review roadmap monthly.
- [] 20.3.09 - Remove or revise unrealistic promises.
- [] 20.3.10 - Communicate delays honestly.

20.4 Community and Devlog Continuity

- [] 20.4.01 - Post regular devlog updates.
- [] 20.4.02 - Share before/after improvements.
- [] 20.4.03 - Show bug fixing transparently.
- [] 20.4.04 - Use Shorts for quick progress clips.
- [] 20.4.05 - Use longer videos for milestone devlogs.
- [] 20.4.06 - Avoid revealing private Steam/GitHub data in videos.
- [] 20.4.07 - Credit tools/assets properly.
- [] 20.4.08 - Create player feedback highlights.
- [] 20.4.09 - Build a mailing list or Discord only if manageable.

☐ 20.4.10 - Keep community expectations grounded.

20.5 Final Long-Term Completion

☐ 20.5.01 - Define what version 1.0 means.

☐ 20.5.02 - Review all Early Access promises.

☐ 20.5.03 - Cut features that do not serve the core game.

☐ 20.5.04 - Polish tutorial/onboarding.

☐ 20.5.05 - Polish performance.

☐ 20.5.06 - Polish UI and accessibility.

☐ 20.5.07 - Polish NPC AI variety.

☐ 20.5.08 - Polish arena event variety.

☐ 20.5.09 - Prepare 1.0 trailer.

☐ 20.5.10 - Prepare 1.0 Steam announcement.

☐ 20.5.11 - Launch 1.0 only when core promise is fulfilled.

Appendix A - Steam Asset Quick Reference

Use the current Steamworks documentation as the source of truth before final export. These dimensions are included as a working production checklist.

Asset	Required?	Working Size / Notes
Header Capsule	Required	920 x 430 px
Small Capsule	Required	462 x 174 px; smaller capsules are generated from it
Main Capsule	Required	1232 x 706 px
Vertical Capsule	Required	748 x 896 px
Screenshots	Required	Minimum 1920 x 1080 or larger, 16:9
Shortcut Icon	Required	256 x 256 .ico or .png
App Icon	Required	184 x 184 .jpg
Library Capsule	Required	600 x 900 px
Library Hero	Required	3840 x 1240 .png
Library Logo	Required	Transparent .png, 1280 wide and/or 720 tall

- [] A.01 - Check every asset against current Steamworks templates before upload.
- [] A.02 - Keep layered source files for all capsules.
- [] A.03 - Ensure product logo/name is readable in small capsule.
- [] A.04 - Do not include awards, review scores, or unsupported claims unless Steam rules allow it.
- [] A.05 - Make sure screenshots represent actual gameplay.
- [] A.06 - Do not use copyrighted third-party imagery or confusing franchise references.

Appendix B - Daily Development Session Checklist

- [] B.01 - Pull latest Git changes.
- [] B.02 - Open Unreal project.
- [] B.03 - Open the correct test map.
- [] B.04 - Write today's one goal in dev notes.
- [] B.05 - Open the relevant Blueprint or asset.
- [] B.06 - Give Codex/NoGlyph one precise task only.
- [] B.07 - Review changes before testing.
- [] B.08 - Compile Blueprints.
- [] B.09 - Save all modified assets.
- [] B.10 - Run Play-In-Editor test.
- [] B.11 - Record bugs immediately.
- [] B.12 - Fix compile/runtime blockers.
- [] B.13 - Run the relevant checklist test.
- [] B.14 - Commit working changes.
- [] B.15 - Push to GitHub.
- [] B.16 - Write a one-paragraph devlog note.
- [] B.17 - Record a short clip/screenshot if visually useful.
- [] B.18 - Close Unreal cleanly.

Appendix C - Source Notes Used for Publishing Checklist

Always re-check official docs before final submission because Steam and Unreal requirements can change. Sources consulted for this checklist:

- [] Confirm current source before launch - Unreal Engine 5.7 Packaging Your Project documentation - <https://dev.epicgames.com/documentation/unreal-engine/packaging-your-project>

- [] Confirm current source before launch - Unreal Engine Packaging and Cooking Games documentation - <https://dev.epicgames.com/documentation/unreal-engine/packaging-and-cooking-games-in-unreal-engine>
- [] Confirm current source before launch - NoGlyph Blueprint Stack documentation - <https://www.noglyphstudio.com/blueprintstack/docs>
- [] Confirm current source before launch - Steamworks Getting Started / Onboarding - <https://partner.steamgames.com/doc/gettingstarted/onboarding>
- [] Confirm current source before launch - Steam Direct Fee documentation - <https://partner.steamgames.com/doc/gettingstarted/appfee>
- [] Confirm current source before launch - Steamworks Store Graphical Assets overview - <https://partner.steamgames.com/doc/store/assets>
- [] Confirm current source before launch - Steamworks Store Graphical Asset Rules - <https://partner.steamgames.com/doc/store/assets/rules>
- [] Confirm current source before launch - Steamworks Uploading to Steam / SteamPipe - <https://partner.steamgames.com/doc/sdk/uploading>
- [] Confirm current source before launch - Steamworks Builds documentation - <https://partner.steamgames.com/doc/store/application/builds>
- [] Confirm current source before launch - Steamworks Review Process documentation - https://partner.steamgames.com/doc/store/review_process
- [] Confirm current source before launch - Steamworks Coming Soon documentation - https://partner.steamgames.com/doc/store/coming_soon
- [] Confirm current source before launch - Steamworks Release Process documentation - <https://partner.steamgames.com/doc/store/releasing>